

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Poverty, Inequality, Social Sector and Inclusive Growth - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Poverty, Inequality, Social Sector and Inclusive Growth REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01 FOUNDATION — POVERTY AND INEQUALITY Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality	02 FOUNDATION — ABSOLUTE AND RELATIVE POVERTY Mechanism chain: Headcount and poverty gap Qualified use: Trace
03 FOUNDATION — HEADCOUNT RATIO AND POVERTY GAP Mechanism chain: Poverty-line vintage Qualified use: Combine	04 CORE — POVERTY-LINE METHOD AND VINTAGE Mechanism chain: Tendulkar and Rangarajan Qualified use: Fix the
05 CORE — TENDULKAR AND RANGARAJAN METHODS The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini	06 CORE — LORENZ CURVE AND GINI COEFFICIENT India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an
07 CORE — NATIONAL MULTIDIMENSIONAL POVERTY INDEX Mechanism chain: Observed and projected MPI Qualified use: Fix the	08 CORE — MPI HEADCOUNT, INTENSITY AND FORMULA Mechanism chain: Inclusive-growth frame Qualified use: Trace social
09 CORE — OBSERVED AND PROJECTED MPI ESTIMATES The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial	10 CORE — INCLUSIVE GROWTH Mechanism chain: Social-sector spending chain Qualified use: Fix the
11 CORE — GROWTH ELASTICITY OF POVERTY Mechanism chain: Universal and targeted provision - Social assistance	12 CORE — SOCIAL-SECTOR SPENDING RESULTS CHAIN MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural
13 CORE SYNTHESIS — UNIVERSAL PROVISION AND TARGETING Mechanism chain: NFSA boundary Qualified use: Fix the poverty or	14 CORE SYNTHESIS — SOCIAL ASSISTANCE, INSURANCE AND PUBLIC SERVICES Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but
15 CORE SYNTHESIS — MGNREGA, NFSA, HEALTH PROTECTION, FINANCE AND SHOCK RESPONSE DD Poverty can fall on a chosen line while inequality (Gini) rises if	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. Uses the same source-bounded Economy distinctions and strict A-B-C-D rotation.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Poverty and inequality boundary?

A. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. B. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. C. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. D. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series.

Answer: A. Explanation: Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Poverty and inequality boundary?

A. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. B. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. C. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. D. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line.

Answer: B. Explanation: Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses Poverty and inequality boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. B. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. C. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. D. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Answer: C. Explanation: Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Poverty and inequality boundary?

A. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. B. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. C. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. D. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.

Answer: D. Explanation: Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Absolute and relative poverty?

A. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. B. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. C. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. D. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line.

Answer: A. Explanation: Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Absolute and relative poverty?

A. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. B. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. C. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. D. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Answer: B. Explanation: Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses Absolute and relative poverty without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. B. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. C. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. D. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.

Answer: C. Explanation: Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Absolute and relative poverty?

A. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. B. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. C. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. D. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard.

Answer: D. Explanation: Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Headcount and poverty gap?

A. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. B. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. C. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. D. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Answer: A. Explanation: The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Headcount and poverty gap?

A. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. B. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. C. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. D. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.

Answer: B. Explanation: The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Headcount and poverty gap without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. B. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. C. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. D. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A.

Answer: C. Explanation: The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Headcount and poverty gap?

A. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. B. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. C. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. D. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Poverty-line vintage?

A. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. B. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. C. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. D. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.

Answer: A. Explanation: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Poverty-line vintage?

A. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. B. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. C. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. D. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A.

Answer: B. Explanation: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Poverty-line vintage without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. B. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. C. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. D. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

Answer: C. Explanation: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Poverty-line vintage?

A. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. B. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. C. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. D. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series.

Answer: D. Explanation: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Tendulkar and Rangarajan?

A. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. B. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. C. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. D. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Tendulkar and Rangarajan?

A. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. B. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. C. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. D. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses Tendulkar and Rangarajan without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. B. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. C. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. D. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Tendulkar and Rangarajan?

A. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. B. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. C. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. D. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Lorenz curve and Gini?

A. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. B. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. C. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. D. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Lorenz curve and Gini?

A. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. B. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. C. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. D. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses Lorenz curve and Gini without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. B. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. C. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. D. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Lorenz curve and Gini?

A. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. B. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. C. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. D. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies MPI architecture?

A. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. B. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. C. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. D. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Answer: A. Explanation: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MPI architecture?

A. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. B. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. C. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. D. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.

Answer: B. Explanation: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses MPI architecture without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. B. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. C. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. D. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MPI architecture?

A. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. B. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. C. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. D. India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.

Answer: D. Explanation: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies MPI formula?

A. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. B. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. C. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. D. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.

Answer: A. Explanation: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MPI formula?

A. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. B. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. C. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. D. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses MPI formula without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. B. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. C. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. D. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.

Answer: C. Explanation: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MPI formula?

A. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. B. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. C. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. D. The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A.

Answer: D. Explanation: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Observed and projected MPI?

A. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. B. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. C. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. D. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Observed and projected MPI?

A. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. B. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. C. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. D. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.

Answer: B. Explanation: The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses Observed and projected MPI without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. B. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. C. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. D. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services.

Answer: C. Explanation: The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Observed and projected MPI?

A. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. B. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. C. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. D. The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

Answer: D. Explanation: The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Inclusive-growth frame?

A. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. B. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. C. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. D. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.

Answer: A. Explanation: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Inclusive-growth frame?

A. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. B. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. C. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. D. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services.

Answer: B. Explanation: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses Inclusive-growth frame without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. B. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. C. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. D. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met.

Answer: C. Explanation: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Inclusive-growth frame?

A. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. B. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. C. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. D. Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Answer: D. Explanation: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Growth elasticity of poverty?

A. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. B. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. C. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. D. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services.

Answer: A. Explanation: The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Growth elasticity of poverty?

A. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. B. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. C. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. D. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met.

Answer: B. Explanation: The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses Growth elasticity of poverty without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. B. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. C. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. D. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Growth elasticity of poverty?

A. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. B. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. C. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. D. The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.

Answer: D. Explanation: The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Social-sector spending chain?

A. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. B. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. C. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. D. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met.

Answer: A. Explanation: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Social-sector spending chain?

A. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. B. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. C. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. D. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses Social-sector spending chain without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. B. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. C. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. D. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality.

Answer: C. Explanation: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Social-sector spending chain?

A. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. B. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. C. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. D. Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Universal and targeted provision?

A. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. B. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. C. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. D. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Universal and targeted provision?

A. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. B. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. C. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. D. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality.

Answer: B. Explanation: Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses Universal and targeted provision without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. B. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. C. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. D. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit.

Answer: C. Explanation: Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Universal and targeted provision?

A. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. B. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. C. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. D. Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.

Answer: D. Explanation: Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Social assistance and insurance?

A. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. B. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. C. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. D. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Social assistance and insurance?

A. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. B. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. C. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. D. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses Social assistance and insurance without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. B. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. C. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. D. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Social assistance and insurance?

A. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. B. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. C. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. D. Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies MGNREGA boundary?

A. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. B. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. C. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. D. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit.

Answer: A. Explanation: MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MGNREGA boundary?

A. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. B. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. C. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. D. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Answer: B. Explanation: MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses MGNREGA boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. B. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. C. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. D. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability.

Answer: C. Explanation: MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MGNREGA boundary?

A. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. B. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. C. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. D. MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met.

Answer: D. Explanation: MGNREGA is a demand-driven legal employment guarantee for rural households, not an unconditional cash transfer or proof that every demand for work was met. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA boundary?

A. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. B. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. C. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. D. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA boundary?

A. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. B. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. C. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. D. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses NFSA boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. B. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. C. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. D. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA boundary?

A. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. B. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. C. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. D. The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Food Security Act creates legal food and nutrition entitlements through an in-kind architecture; statutory coverage rules and actual beneficiary inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Health-protection boundary?

A. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. B. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. C. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. D. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability.

Answer: A. Explanation: Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Health-protection boundary?

A. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. B. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. C. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. D. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.

Answer: B. Explanation: Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses Health-protection boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. B. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. C. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. D. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard.

Answer: C. Explanation: Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Health-protection boundary?

A. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. B. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. C. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. D. Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality.

Answer: D. Explanation: Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Financial inclusion?

A. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. B. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. C. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. D. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.

Answer: A. Explanation: Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Financial inclusion?

A. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. B. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. C. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. D. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard.

Answer: B. Explanation: Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses Financial inclusion without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. B. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. C. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. D. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Financial inclusion?

A. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. B. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. C. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. D. Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit.

Answer: D. Explanation: Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Intergenerational and spatial inequality?

A. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. B. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. C. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. D. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard.

Answer: A. Explanation: Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Intergenerational and spatial inequality?

A. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. B. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. C. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. D. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Intergenerational and spatial inequality without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. B. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. C. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. D. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series.

Answer: C. Explanation: Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Intergenerational and spatial inequality?

A. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. B. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. C. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. D. Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Answer: D. Explanation: Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Shock-responsive inclusion?

A. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. B. Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. C. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. D. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Shock-responsive inclusion?

A. Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. B. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. C. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. D. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series.

Answer: B. Explanation: Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Shock-responsive inclusion without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. B. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. C. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. D. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line.

Answer: C. Explanation: Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal

sustainability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Shock-responsive inclusion?

A. A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. B. The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. C. The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. D. Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability.

Answer: D. Explanation: Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Semantic-completeness coverage drills - Topic 23

Use each drill as a 60-second plan before returning to the solved PYQs.

Drill	Prompt	Minimum answer route	Fatal trap
A	How did irrigation connect agrarian expansion and state formation?	tank/well/channel -> settlement and cultivation -> shared maintenance -> revenue/institution -> regional limit	uniform state hydraulic system
B	Distinguish <i>brahmadeya</i> , <i>agrahara</i> and <i>devadana</i> .	beneficiary/purpose -> chartered rights -> formula-versus-practice caution	calling every grant identical
C	Were Pallava-Chalukya states centralized empires?	core -> intermediaries -> local bodies -> tribute/campaign zones -> graded verdict	campaign equals province
D	Compare state models.	feudal -> segmentary -> integrative -> peasantization -> evidence-sensitive synthesis	treating one model as settled fact
E	Was Brahmanization one-way cultural replacement?	grant and migration -> status/ritual -> local cult adaptation -> language localization -> unequal reciprocity	homogenization
F	What does multilingual epigraphy prove?	Prakrit/Sanskrit/Tamil/Kannada and bounded Telugu transition -> institutional audience -> literacy limit	language equals ethnicity
G	What can queenly patronage prove?	Lokamahadevi/Virupaksha and Trailokyamahadevi/Mallikarjuna -> elite agency -> no universal gender claim	general equality from two patrons
H	Where does Topic 23 end?	Rashtrakuta takeover c. 753 and continuing Vengi line -> bounded Chola link	all Chalukyas vanish together

Self-check model: every response should contain one named item of evidence, one mechanism, one source or regional limit and one qualified conclusion.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route Mains demands on inclusive growth, inter-generational equity, financial inclusion, community health and social-service expenditure, plus the objective poverty-line variation concept. These demands are solved or retained in practice without inventing an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Define the economic concept and state the exact identity, classification, unit, denominator and stock-flow status. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, regulatory, budgetary or executive authority and the programme's operative stage. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Trace the shock or instrument through prices, quantities, balance sheets, expectations and incentives with explicit lags. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named India-centric dataset, institution, policy, market or programme with source, release date and reference period. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Evaluate growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and Centre-state or intergovernmental effects. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test causal identification, data revision, fiscal cost, external constraint, implementation capacity and residual trade-offs. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal

constraints.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Social-service public expenditure and inclusive growth after reforms.
- ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: HDI versus IHDI as an inclusive-growth indicator.
- ANALYSIS: **Social-expenditure answer route:** distinguish allocation from actual spending, spending from service quality, and national average from state/district outcomes; then link health, education, nutrition and protection to jobs, capabilities and fiscal sustainability.
- ANALYSIS: 2022 GS-III: Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under a market economy - answer with the PMJDY-access plus RBI FI-Index (Access/Usage/Quality) evidence above.
- ANALYSIS: 2022 GS-III: Community health challenges from rising life expectancy - answer with the SRS life-expectancy figure, the NCD burden and the Ayushman Bharat HWC response above.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "9. PYQ application", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "9. PYQ application".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Social-service public expenditure and inclusive growth after reforms. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: HDI versus IHDI as an inclusive-growth indicator. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: Social-expenditure answer route: distinguish allocation from actual spending, **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** spending from service quality, and national average from state/district outcomes; then **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity,

balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** link health, education, nutrition and protection to jobs, capabilities and fiscal

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2022 GS-III: Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under a market economy - answer **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "9. PYQ application".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "9. PYQ application", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	1	Public expenditure on social services post-reforms and inclusive growth	Examine · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Public expenditure on social services post-reforms and inclusive growth

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.

Answer-key rule: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 5

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-III	11	Inclusive growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	24	Official poverty line variation across Indian states	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	GS-III	1	Intra and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	2	Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under market economy	State · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	5	Community health challenges from rising life expectancy in India	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Inclusive growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives
- Official poverty line variation across Indian states
- Intra and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth
- Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under market economy
- Community health challenges from rising life expectancy in India

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Social-service public expenditure and inclusive growth after reforms.
- ANALYSIS: 2025 GS-III: HDI versus IHDI as an inclusive-growth indicator.
- ANALYSIS: **Social-expenditure answer engine:** allocation -> release -> actual spending ->

service availability/quality -> household outcome; disaggregate by state, group and rural/urban access before claiming inclusive growth.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2019, 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	GS-III	11	Inclusive growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives	Comment · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2020	GS-III	1	Intra and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	2	Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under market economy	State · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	5	Community health challenges from rising life expectancy in India	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Inclusive growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives
- Intra and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth
- Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under market economy
- Community health challenges from rising life expectancy in India

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: Inclusive-growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Inclusive-growth strategy for inclusiveness and sustainability objectives.
Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.
Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2019 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2020 GS-III

Demand: Intra- and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: Lorenz curve and Gini: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2020 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Lorenz curve and Gini: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Intra- and inter-generational equity in inclusive growth. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Lorenz curve and Gini: The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Growth elasticity of poverty:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2020 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under a market economy.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: **Inclusive-growth frame:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Financial inclusion:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Inclusive-growth frame:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Financial inclusion:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Financial inclusion and inclusive growth under a market economy.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and

federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Inclusive-growth frame: Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Financial inclusion:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2022 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Community-health challenges arising from rising life expectancy in India.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: Social-sector spending chain: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Social assistance and insurance:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Social-sector spending chain: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Social assistance and insurance:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Community-health challenges arising from rising life expectancy in India. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Social-sector spending chain: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Social assistance and insurance:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Shock-responsive inclusion:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Public expenditure on social services after reforms and its relationship with inclusive growth.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: **Inclusive-growth frame:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Social-sector spending chain:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Inclusive-growth frame:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Social-sector spending chain: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Public expenditure on social services after reforms and its relationship with inclusive growth. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Inclusive-growth frame:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.

Social-sector spending chain: Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Universal and targeted provision:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Health-protection boundary:** Hospitalisation insurance can

reduce catastrophic inpatient costs but cannot by itself replace primary care, public-health capacity, outpatient access or service quality. **Intergenerational and spatial inequality:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish poverty incidence, poverty depth and inequality. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Absolute and relative poverty. **Named evidence/example:** Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.
- Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard.
- The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.
- The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Absolute and relative poverty. **Named evidence/example:** Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish poverty incidence, poverty depth and inequality. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Absolute and relative poverty. **Named evidence/example:** Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Absolute and relative poverty. **Named evidence/example:** Absolute poverty uses a defined minimum standard, while relative poverty evaluates position against the prevailing distribution or social standard. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish poverty incidence, poverty depth and inequality. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why must the 2022-23 national MPI estimate be separated from NFHS-5 observations? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named**

evidence/example: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named**

evidence/example: The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.
- The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$.
- The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named**

evidence/example: The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow

distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why must the 2022-23 national MPI estimate be separated from NFHS-5 observations? Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional

benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Why must the 2022-23 national MPI estimate be separated from NFHS-5 observations? Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain why growth can reduce poverty while increasing inequality. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises.
- Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.
- The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.
- Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why growth can reduce poverty while increasing inequality. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public

services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Poverty and inequality boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Poverty measures shortfall below a stated threshold, while inequality measures dispersion across a distribution; poverty can fall even when inequality rises. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:**

Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why growth can reduce poverty while increasing inequality. Answer in about 250 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Evaluate targeting against universal public services in India's social sector. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social assistance and insurance. **Named evidence/example:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and

rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.
- Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.
- Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services.
- Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social assistance and insurance. **Named evidence/example:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate targeting against universal public services in India's social sector. Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social assistance and insurance.

Named evidence/example: Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other,

while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social assistance and insurance. **Named evidence/example:** Social assistance is generally tax-financed support based on need or category, while social insurance pools contributions or specified risks; both differ from universal public services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate targeting against universal public services in India's social sector. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design an inclusive-growth strategy combining jobs, services, redistribution and shock protection. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty.

Named evidence/example: The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies

the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Financial inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Shock-responsive inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests.
- The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services.
- Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome.
- Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks.
- Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit.
- Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Financial inclusion. **Named**

evidence/example: Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Shock-responsive inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Design an inclusive-growth strategy combining jobs, services, redistribution and shock...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Financial inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Shock-responsive inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Inclusive-growth frame. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive growth combines productive participation, quality public services, redistribution and protection against shocks; growth and distribution are related but distinct tests. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Growth elasticity of poverty. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty reduction generated by growth depends on initial inequality, sectoral composition, labour intensity and access to assets and services. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket,

instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Social-sector spending chain. **Named evidence/example:** Budget allocation, release, actual spending, service availability, service quality and household outcome are separate stages; expenditure is not itself an outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Universal and targeted provision. **Named evidence/example:** Universal public services and targeted benefits can complement each other, while targeting saves resources but creates exclusion, inclusion and transaction-cost risks. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Financial inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Financial inclusion requires access, usage and quality of suitable services; account ownership alone does not prove credit access, income growth or poverty exit. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Shock-responsive inclusion. **Named evidence/example:** Social protection should prevent temporary health, climate or employment shocks from becoming persistent poverty traps while retaining a pathway to productive capability and fiscal sustainability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Design an inclusive-growth strategy combining jobs, services, redistribution and shock...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: How should India measure and address poverty without collapsing methodology, distribution and capability into one indicator? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Poverty-line vintage. **Named evidence/example:** A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Tendulkar and Rangarajan. **Named evidence/example:**

The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation.
- A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series.
- The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line.
- The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results.
- India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators.
- The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A.
- The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey.

- Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Poverty-line vintage.

Named evidence/example: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Tendulkar and Rangarajan. **Named evidence/example:** The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI architecture.

Named evidence/example: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "How should India measure and address poverty without collapsing methodology, distribution and...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Poverty-line vintage.

Named evidence/example: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Tendulkar and Rangarajan. **Named evidence/example:** The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI architecture.

Named evidence/example: India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every deprivation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation

and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as MPI equals H multiplied by A. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
7. **Claim and named evidence:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
8. **Claim and named evidence:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Headcount and poverty gap. **Named evidence/example:** The poverty headcount ratio measures incidence, while the poverty gap captures average depth below the line; neither alone describes every

deprivation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Poverty-line vintage.

Named evidence/example: A poverty estimate is inseparable from its line, price basis, survey, reference period and methodology; estimates from different vintages should not be presented as one continuous series. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Tendulkar and Rangarajan. **Named evidence/example:** The Tendulkar and Rangarajan expert-group methods use different consumption baskets and thresholds; neither should be mislabeled as a timeless current official poverty line. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Lorenz curve and Gini. **Named evidence/example:** The Lorenz curve represents cumulative distribution, while the Gini coefficient summarises inequality; income, consumption and wealth data can produce different results. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI architecture. **Named evidence/example:** India's national Multidimensional Poverty Index follows an Alkire-Foster structure across health, education and standard-of-living dimensions using twelve indicators. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** MPI formula. **Named evidence/example:** The multidimensional poverty index combines the headcount ratio of multidimensionally poor people with their average intensity of deprivation, conventionally expressed as $MPI = H \times A$. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Observed and projected MPI. **Named evidence/example:** The 2019-21 national MPI estimate is tied to NFHS-5 observations, while NITI Aayog's 2022-23 figure is an estimate projected from earlier reduction trends rather than a fresh household survey. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Intergenerational and spatial inequality. **Named evidence/example:** Inclusive-growth analysis must examine mobility across generations and disparities across states, districts, social groups, gender and rural-urban locations rather than rely on a national average. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "How should India measure and address poverty without collapsing methodology, distribution and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.